

AP



OMAR IS SEEKING
POLITICAL ASYLUM

MADRID | Prodigal Son

His father Osama Bin Laden may have turned an illegal immigrant for the United States, but one of his sons, Omar Osama bin Laden wants to take the legal route. The 27-year-old Saudi national landed at Madrid airport on November 3 seeking political asylum. One of Osama's 19 children, Omar hogged the headlines last year when he married a 51-year-old British grandmother. But earlier this year, Britain denied him a visa to stay in the UK. Omar maintains that he is a pacifist, has not seen his father since he was 19 and that Osama may not be behind 9/11 terror attacks. However, it is unlikely that his pedigree will impress Spanish authorities while deciding on his political asylum status.

6.7

billion, the world's population, with China's 1.3b winning them another gold.



MUSHARRAF IS
LYING LOW

AFP

ISLAMABAD | General in His Labyrinth

It is a retirement package Pakistan's former President General Pervez Musharraf may not have bargained for—amnesty if he stays politically inactive. Pakistan's Premier Yusuf Raza Gilani has confirmed this in an interview: "He keeps a low profile and is not politically active. If he stays this way, then we would not want to open too many fronts." Musharraf seized power through a military coup in 1999. He was forced to step down in August after the ruling coalition led by Gilani's Pakistan People's Party and

Nawaz Sharif's Pakistan Muslim League threatened to impeach him if he did not step down. Although the Pakistan National Assembly has not yet decided on Musharraf's future, the Government is not seeking further punishment for him, says Gilani. The former President maintains an elaborate security setup and shuttles between Karachi and Islamabad. Despite speculation that he may seek refuge in the US or Turkey, perhaps the hopes of a second coming have made him stay on in Pakistan. *by Saurabh Shukla*

TECH STOP

Power of Seven

GIVEN THE FURORE over the many bugs infesting their much-hyped Vista operating system, the folks at Windows have gone into damage control mode. A pre-beta version of their new operating system, Windows 7, is here and is on trial. The core of the system is still Vista, but fortunately, that's all that it is. The system met with



rave reviews at the annual Microsoft Hardware Engineering Conference in Los Angeles last week. With full-fledged touch and multi-touch features like flick and gestures, Windows 7 will feature an enhanced Taskbar, Jump Lists and an even more glass-like Aero interface which promises to deliver flexibility and functionality. Microsoft claims that the os will also run on lower-end netbooks.

WINDOWS 7 WILL FEATURE AN ENHANCED TASKBAR, JUMP LISTS AND PROMISES FLEXIBILITY AND FUNCTIONALITY.